PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Toyota Land Cruiser FJ62

1988–1990 · FJ62 · 3F-E 4.0 I6

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Rear frame rails**
  Corsetti says this is the most important check on any 60: drop the spare if necessary and inspect the rear frame rails. Rusted through means walk away.
- [ ] **The usual 60 rust spots**
  Windshield gasket corners, roof drip rails, tailgate hinge areas, inner and outer rear wheel wells, front fenders and rockers. Trucks from salted-road states rust fast; a magnet finds filler around the wheel wells and tailgate.
- [ ] **Find the oil leak**
  Most will have one. Before blaming the rear main seal, IH8MUD members suggest checking that the oil pan bolts are torqued to spec and that the valve cover gasket isn't the real culprit.
- [ ] **Rough idle**
  Usually a tune-up item or a vacuum leak rather than anything serious, but it's a useful bargaining point.
- [ ] **Test the A/C and the 4WD**
  Check that the A/C compressor engages; it may just need a recharge. Engage four-wheel drive and low range on a loose surface and make sure the push-button system works.
- [ ] **Knuckles and steering**
  Look for sludge at the front knuckles, and drive it to check for wobble or wander, especially on a lifted truck.
- [ ] **Power-steering leaks**
  A wet, shiny driver's-side axle and spring usually means the power-steering box or pump is leaking.
- [ ] **Ask about the transfer case**
  IH8MUD members treated a transfer-case rebuild at 74,000 miles as a red flag on one truck. Ask why any major driveline work was done.

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- [ ] **Rear lap belt may not retract**
  1982–1988 · NHTSA 89V155000
- [ ] **Fuel tank welds can crack**
  1980–1990 · NHTSA 91V110000

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Engine**
  US FJ62s have the fuel-injected 3F-E (155 hp), which in the US was also used in the 1991–92 FJ80. Venezuelan FJ62s built to 1992 used a carbureted 3F.
- [ ] **Transmission**
  US trucks came only with the A440F four-speed automatic. A manual FJ62 has been converted, usually to an H55F.

- [ ] **Looks**
  Square headlights and the facelifted front end set it apart from the round-headlight FJ60.
- [ ] **JDM VX**
  The Japanese-market FJ62G VX launched in 1987. Right-hand-drive VX imports are gray-market, not US trucks.

NOTES

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